8 Handling files

We can go on and on about making straightforward applications that start, perform something and then end without saving any data for later use. But the fact is, most real world-applications need to store data in your application folder in flies, be it the files that you downloaded into memory from a remote server or user data meant for long-term storage that should persist even after the application shuts down and restarts.

8.1 About your application directories

Before we make an application that is capable of navigating into files and sub-directories, we need to understand the home directory concept of iPhone applications. Every time, you create an application, the following sub-directories are created and made available to you:

The typical libraries in an iPhone application

Applications: This is the directory that contains your application bundle, including the xib files generated by Xcode, localizations, executable code and the .app file that contains all other embedded resources.

Libraries: This folder is the parent to the Preferences directory of your application, where files written using the preferences APIs like